

Dental Examination Prior to Kidney Transplantation

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

260.6

Manual Section Title

Dental Examination Prior to Kidney Transplantation

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

01/01/1979

Description Information

Benefit Category

Inpatient Hospital Services

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Despite the "dental services exclusion" in §1862(a)(12) of the Act (see the [Medicare Benefit Policy Manual](#) [↗], Chapter 16, "General Exclusions from Coverage," §140), an oral or dental examination performed on an inpatient basis as part of a comprehensive workup prior to renal transplant surgery is a covered service. This is because the purpose of the examination is not for the care of the teeth or structures directly supporting the teeth. Rather, the examination is for the identification, prior to a complex surgical procedure, of existing medical problems where the increased possibility of infection would not only reduce the chances for successful surgery but would also expose the patient to additional risks in undergoing such surgery.

Such a dental or oral examination would be covered under Part A of the program if performed by a dentist on the hospital's staff, or under Part B if performed by a physician. (When performing a dental or oral examination, a dentist is not recognized as a physician under §1861(r) of the Act.) (See the [Medicare General Information, Eligibility, and Entitlement Manual](#) , Chapter 5, "Definitions," §70.2, and the Medicare Benefit and Entitlement Manual, Chapter 15, "Covered Medical and Other Health Services," §150.)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

36

Revision History

5/1989 - Added statutory authority citation. Effective date NA. (TN 36)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Dental Examination Prior to Kidney Transplantation	1	01/01/1979 - N/A	You are here